

NR2DT-02: Step 2 — Strategize

Series: NR2DT — New Relic to Dynatrace Migration Steps | **Notebook:** 2 of 10 |
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Overview

Goal of this step: turn the discovery output into a wave plan, scope decisions, and gate definitions for the rest of the migration. Stakeholders sign off here.

Procedural — if you want the *why* behind wave ordering or trade-offs, the relevant NRLC component notebooks have it.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Audience	Migration lead + assigned engineer for this step
Completed	NR2DT-01 — Discover

Requirement	Details
Format	Procedural step — use as a runbook; defer to NRLC for depth
NRLC deep dives	Each component NRLC notebook for trade-off depth

1. What You'll Produce

Artifact	Format	Purpose
<code>wave-plan.md</code>	Markdown	Sequenced delivery plan with owners and timing
<code>scope-decisions.md</code>	Markdown	What's in / out / deferred / dropped
<code>gate-definitions.md</code>	Markdown	Pass criteria for each wave's exit
<code>stakeholder-signoff.md</code>	Markdown	Who approved what, when

2. The Standard Wave Plan

Use this as a starting template; adjust for your inventory.

Wave	Components	Risk	Typical Duration	Owner
0 — Foundations	Bucket strategy, host groups, IAM groups, OpenPipeline enrichments	Low	1–2 weeks	Platform team
1 — Dashboards (read-only)	All migrated dashboards	Low	1 week + dual-run	Each team owns its dashboards
2 — Synthetics	HTTP first, then Browser, then API	Medium	1–2 weeks	SRE

Wave	Components	Risk	Typical Duration	Owner
3 — Alerts (HIGH RISK)	Metric Events + Workflows; dual-alert window	High	2–3 weeks (with dual-alert)	On-call leads
4 — SLOs	All SLOs after the underlying metrics are stable	Medium	1 week + 7-day delta	SRE + service owners
5 — Logs / Drops / Tags	OpenPipeline filter and enrichment rules	Low	1–2 weeks	Platform + FinOps
6 — Decommission NR	Disable routes, archive dashboards, halt ingest	Low (after sign-off)	1 week	Platform + leadership

Each wave has an exit gate (defined in §4). Don't run waves in parallel until you have explicit approval — the gates are sequenced for a reason.



3. Scope Decisions

Discovery surfaces things that don't fit the standard pattern. Decide explicitly for each:

Category	Decision Required
LOW-confidence NRQL queries	Translate manually, reformulate, or drop the artifact
APM conditions	Replace with Dynatrace Intelligence adaptive baselines (recommended) or hand-port
Scripted browser monitors	Rebuild as DT clickpaths or drop
Custom NR Nerdpacks	Out of scope (no DT equivalent)
Historical NRDB data	Not migrated (configuration only)
Multi-account NR setup	Becomes single tenant + buckets + OpenPipeline enrichment + IAM scoping

Document each decision in `scope-decisions.md` with the rationale and the impacted artifacts.

4. Define the Validation Gates

Each wave has a go/no-go gate. Document the pass criteria up front.

Gate	Question	Pass Criteria
G0 — Foundations	Can DT receive and route data per the bucket strategy?	Test ingestion lands in the correct bucket; IAM scopes work
G1 — Dashboards	Migrated dashboards display the same data shape?	Visual diff sample (10–20%) acceptable
G2 — Synthetics	Migrated synthetics meet SLA continuity?	Availability $\pm 0.5\%$ during dual-run
G3 — Alerts	Dual-alert volume aligned?	DT vs NR alert count within $\pm 10\%$ over 1–2 weeks
G4 — SLOs	SLI math equivalent?	7-day SLI delta $\leq 0.5\%$
G5 — Logs	Log volumes, parsing, drops in line?	Volume $\pm 5\%$; parsed fields present; drops working

Gate	Question	Pass Criteria
G6 — Cutover Ready	Parallel-run period long enough?	≥ 2 weeks of clean dual operation
G7 — Decommission	All stakeholders confirm?	Sign-offs documented; rollback plan still valid

5. Stakeholder Sign-off

Sign-off is per-wave, not at the start. But the **plan** must be approved before Step 3.

Stakeholder	What They Approve
Migration lead	Wave sequence, owners, timeline
On-call leads	Wave 3 (alerts) plan + dual-alert window
Service owners	Their dashboards / alerts / SLOs are in scope
Compliance / Security	IAM model, log retention, audit-trail bucket
FinOps	DPS budget; bucket pricing model
Leadership	Decommission target date

6. Step Exit Criteria

G2 — Strategy Approved

- ☐ `wave-plan.md` complete with owners and timing
- ☐ `scope-decisions.md` covers every gap from Step 1
- ☐ `gate-definitions.md` documents pass criteria for each wave
- ☐ All required stakeholders have signed off on the plan

Next step: NR2DT-03 — Design (target Dynatrace architecture: buckets, host groups, IAM, OpenPipeline).

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